

IDENTIFYING ERIE COUNTY CENSUS TRACTS IN NEED OF, AND ELIGIBLE TO RECEIVE COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT FUNDING

1

Project Goals

The goal of this report is to identify census tracts in Erie County that are comprised of the most vulnerable homeowners in critical need of community development funding for home repairs and other supportive services

Methodology-Identifying Eligible Census Tracts

- Census.gov was utilized to explore and extract relevant data related to the following criteria
 - **Age over 50** (2 cohorts were combined, 50-64 and 65+)
 - **Race-Black**
 - **Homeowner**
- .CSV files were created, and saved as .XLS files in MS EXCEL
- IBM SPSS converted the .XLS files to a .DBF format for use in ArcMap
- ESRI ArcMap helped determine the census tracts according to the three criteria

Problem Statement

Older, African American homeowners face numerous issues that compromises their ability to afford crucial home repairs and maintenance

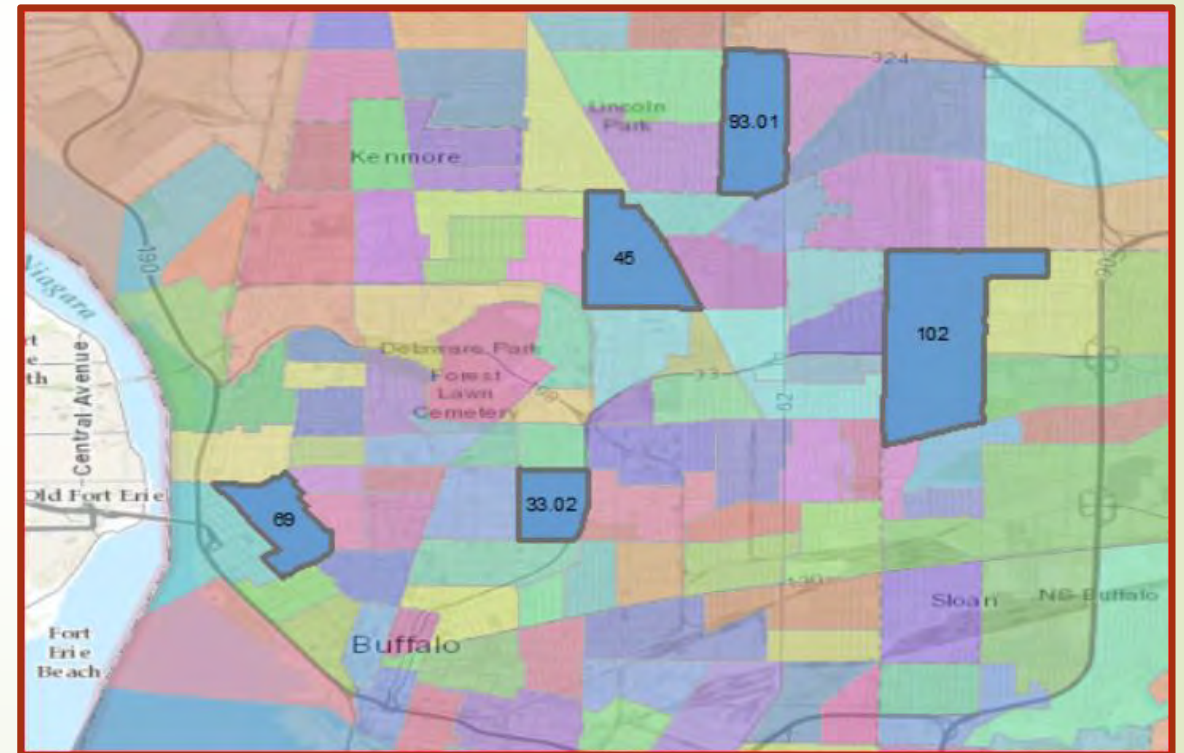
- Fixed Income
- Healthcare premiums
- Loss of Spouse/Spousal Income
- Disability
- Predatory Reverse Mortgage Schemes
- Code Violations fines
- Property Taxes/Liens
- Foreclosure

4

Research Results

5 census tracts in Buffalo, NY satisfy the criteria to be eligible and considered to receive community development funding

Census Tract ID	Census Tract POP 2000	BLACK #	Black %	AGE 50 +	AGE 50+ %	# Housing Units per Census Tract	# Units OWNER Occupied	% Units OWNER Occupied
33.02	4144	3853	93%	1503	36%	2306	696	30%
45	6003	1412	24%	2051	34%	2577	1391	54%
69	8230	1463	18%	1802	22%	4069	908	22%
93.01	5321	840	16%	1503	28%	2451	1323	54%
102	7117	1332	19%	2137	30%	3321	1975	59%

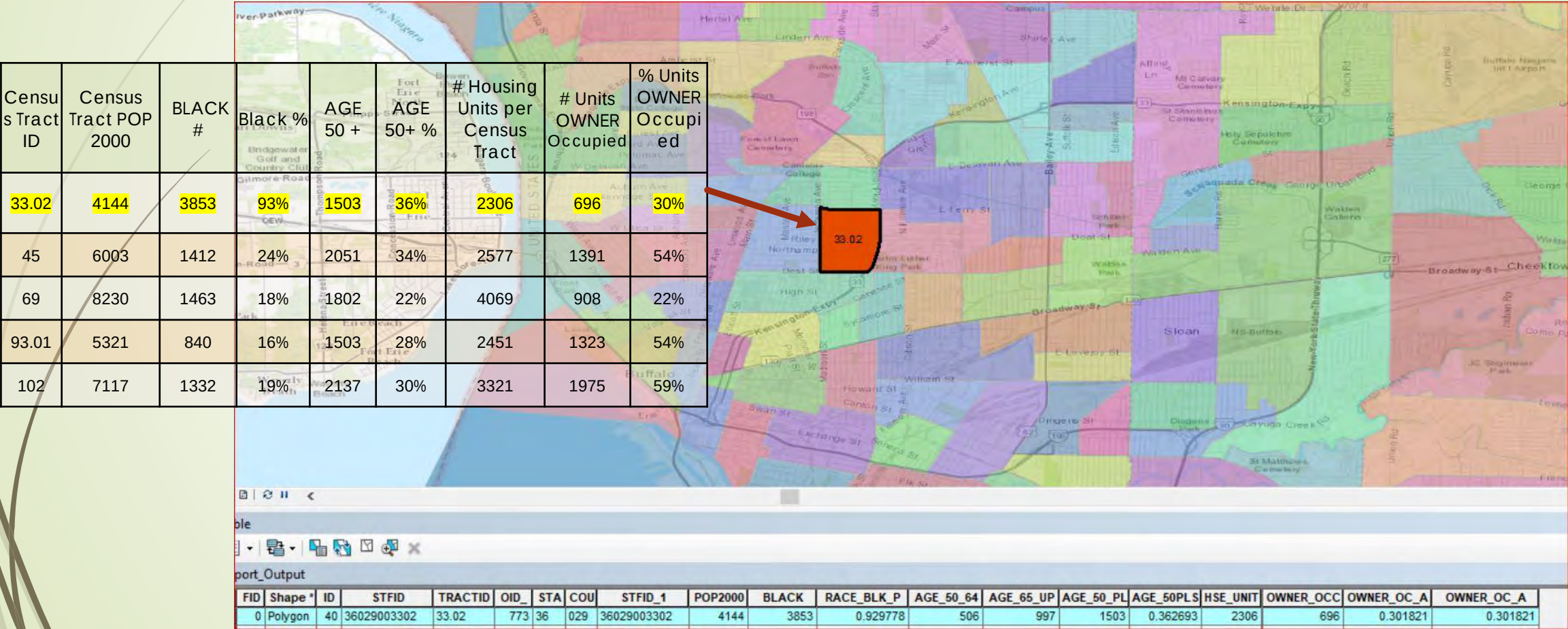


ArcMap

5

Research Results, cont'd.

Out of the five selected census tracts, 33.02 is in the most need for community development funding



Recommendations

- Survey of the housing stock in the identified census tracts
 - Windshield
 - Mail (with return envelope and stamp)
 - In person
- Emergency Housing Repair Grants
 - Code Violations
 - Health and Safety repairs
 - Stairs
 - Roof and plumbing Leaks
 - Security
 - Winterization (coordinate with existing NYSEG programs)
- Technical Guidance and financial assistance to resolve
 - Reverse mortgages
 - Past due property taxes
 - Past due utility balances,

References

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"Reverse Mortgage Motivations and Outcomes:
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ESRI.com/ArcMap